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NATS1755 Assignment #3

Digital Academic Poster

Assignment #3 must be submitted digitally to our eClass course website before Wednesday April 1, 2023 at 11:59pm. This assignment is worth 10% of your final grade.

In lecture we have discussed a variety of types of natural hazards: earthquakes, tsunamis, volcanoes, flooding, landslides, severe weather events, hurricanes and wildfires. Because of the impact they have had on Earth and human society, when these events occur, they immediately appear on social media, news proceedings and internet reports. They are studied and investigated by numerous scientific researchers, and the findings are published in scientific journals, textbooks and government websites. In this assignment, it is now your turn to become a journalist. You will investigate a natural hazard event that happened globally and display your research in the form of a **digital academic poster.**

An academic poster is a visual way of communicating information to a scientific community. Not only does it have to be scientifically accurate and informative, but it also must grab the audience's attention and convey the research in a clear and compelling way. Academic posters are unlike conventional posters; while they are still a creative visualization of research, they are scholarly, formal, and well-referenced. Academic posters are a mixture of text, tables, graphs, pictures, and other presentation formats.

Learning Outcomes:

- Enhance research skills of primary literature
- Critically evaluate sources for accuracy and relevancy
- Enhance understanding of natural hazard event via independent research
- Communicate the science behind a natural hazard event in a visual and creative format

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Part A: Conducting Your Research

In this assignment, you are asked to research a **natural hazard event** that occurred globally at any point in history. The natural hazard event must be one of the following (or a combination of two or more): earthquake, tsunami, volcano, flood, mass wasting/landslide, severe weather event, hurricane and/or wildfire. You can pick an event that was introduced in lecture, as long as you expand significantly on what was already presented. You cannot pick an event from a class case study (i.e. the Haida Gwaii Earthquake or the Mt St Helen's Volcano)

You are welcome to gather data and research from any **scholarly, credible source**: books, government websites (sites ending in .gov), academic websites (sites ending in .edu), scientific research organizations (such as NASA, USGS, NOAA, Environment Canda, etc.) and/or peer-reviewed journal articles. Other sources (i.e. random websites, Generative AI, newspaper or magazine articles, social media posts, etc.) will not be accepted and will result in marks deducted.

From your research, you should be able to answer at least the following questions:

- Where did the event occur (country, city, etc.)?
- When did it occur (day and time, if available)?
- How did it occur (i.e. explain the natural hazard and the processes that led to it)?
- Was human society impacted in any way? If so, how? Were the impacts short or long term?
- Was physical Earth impacted in any way? If so, how? Were the impacts short or long term?
- What lessons were learned (if any) from this event?

Note: these are to *get you started* but be sure to include expand on these questions and add the unique details about your natural hazard event

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Part B: Creating Your Digital Academic Poster

Once your research is complete, you need to design a digital academic poster to highlight and summarize your findings. Your poster needs to be clearly and logically laid out using headings and sub-headings (if needed). You are free to be creative with your academic poster, however elements that must be included are:

A creative and scholarly title	The title should introduce your natural hazard in a creative and academic manner
Introduction	The introduction should *introduce* the reader to your natural hazard event. Preliminary information can be included here that is sets up the rest of the poster.
Main Body of Poster	The main body of your poster is where you will present the research you discovered from Part A. The body of your poster will likely be divided into a variety of headings/sub-headings but should be clear and flow logically. **Remember!** This is not an essay but a poster. Text may be included (though I recommend bullet points rather than paragraphs) but the body of your poster should have lots of visuals (graphs, tables, figures, etc.) that display your research.
Visuals	Your poster **must** contain visuals (graphs, tables, figures, etc.) that displays your research and enhances the aesthetic appeal of your poster. All visuals must be properly referenced by placing a caption under your figure that includes: i. A Figure number ii. A sentence that briefly describes the figure iii. A reference that is included at the end of the sentence in the form of an in-text citation (which should be accompanied with a full reference in the reference section)
Conclusions	To summarize your poster and include information such as lessons learned or next steps
References	Three types of references should be included in your poster: i. In-text citations (found at the end of a sentence of text) ii. Figure citations (found in the caption of a figure) iii. Full reference list (found typically at the bottom-right corner of poster) All references should use APA formatting

Academic Poster Set-Up

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Your academic poster must follow these specifications:

Format	Digital (the poster will not be printed but submitted digitally to eClass)
Software	Any software of your choice can be used. My recommendation: Microsoft PowerPoint or Google Slides and making your poster using a single slide with the proper size specifications (see below)
Size	Your poster must have the following dimensions: width of 120 cm and height of 90 cm To change the size of a slide on PowerPoint: click on "Design" → "Side Size" → "Page Setup" → select "Slide sized for: Custom" → input a width of 120cm and a height of 90cm [or do a Google search to see how this is done for your version of PowerPoint]
Orientation	Landscape Your poster should read from top left to bottom right.
Font	For the main text of the poster, use a font size of 18-25 (This may seem small but it is appropriate for the size of the poster. We will zoom in to mark your poster). A smaller or larger size will result in marks deducted. The main poster title and any headings/subheadings can be a larger font The references section can be a smaller font but should appear directly on the poster (typically on the bottom right corner) [Note: do not put your references on a separate page or slide]
Colour	The design is your choice however be mindful of choosing font and background colours that enhance readability (such as light backgrounds and dark fonts)

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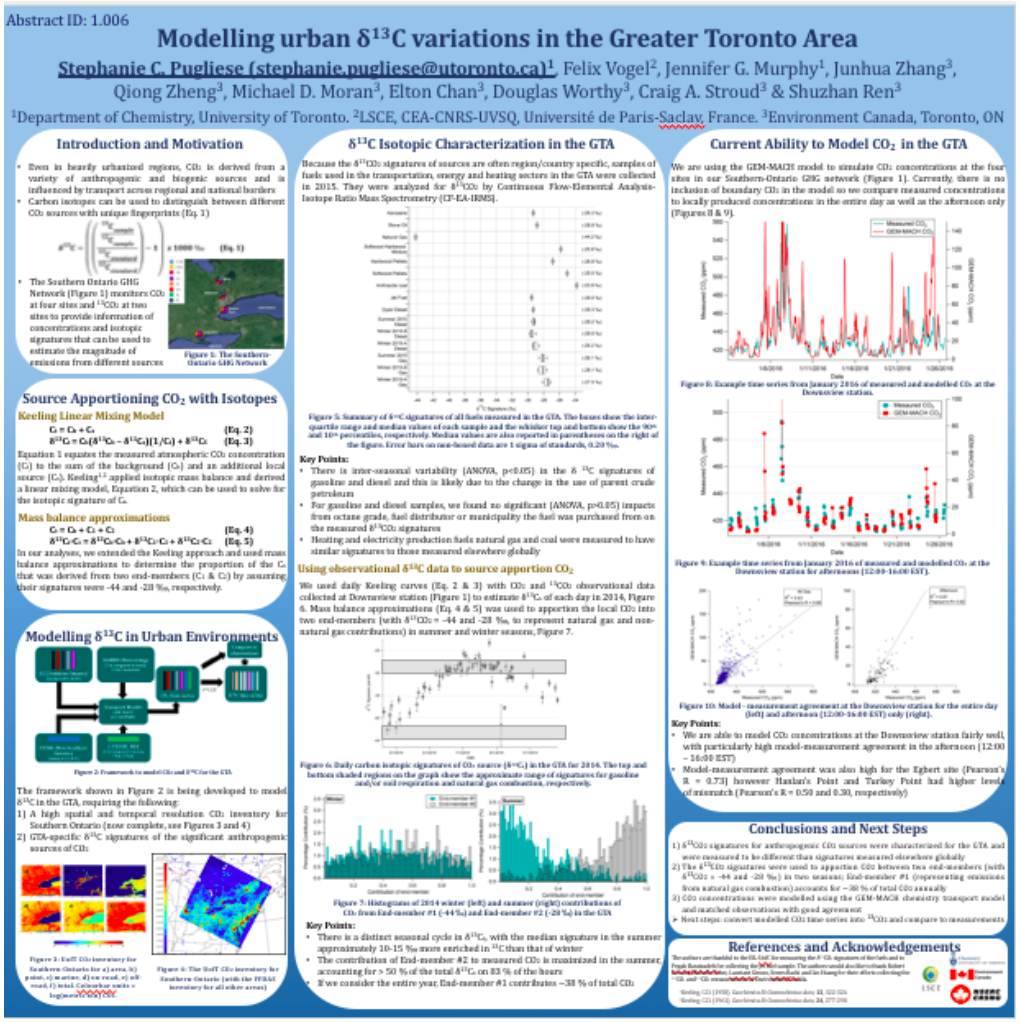
Example Academic Poster

Below is an example academic poster I created when I was a PhD student. It is slightly different than what you will produce as I was presenting original research I had conducted (not research I found in other sources). However, I include it here to give you a visual example of what an academic poster looks like (i.e. the ratio of text to visuals, the choice of colours, the use of references, etc.). Use it as a starting point to inspire your own creative ideas about your academic poster.



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Evaluation Criteria

Points	**Criteria**	**What we are looking for**
2.5	Title	-title is informative, scholarly, creative, not too long
2.5	Natural hazard event	-An appropriate **natural hazard** event was selected from anywhere in the world at any point in time -One of the following (or a combination of two or more): earthquake, tsunami, volcano, flood, mass wasting/landslide, severe weather event, hurricane and/or wildfire. -Not an event covered in a class case study (i.e. the Haida Gwaii Earthquake or the Mt St Helen's Volcano)
5	Readability	-poster is designed such that it would be easily readable if printed (i.e. font colour choices, large enough font size, etc.)
10	Visual Design	-flow of poster is logical and clear (one section leads into another) -a good balance of text and graphics/tables/figures -not cluttered -scholarly in nature (not designed as a conventional poster) -graphics are engaging and enhance the text content -information is presented in an interesting way
25	Scientific information presented	-the information presented on the natural hazard event is scientifically accurate -poster presents information answering: • Where did the event occur (country, city, etc.)? • When did it occur (day and time, if available)? • How did it occur (i.e. explain the natural hazard and the processes that led to it)? • Was human society impacted in any way? If so, how? Were the impacts short or long term? • Was Earth impacted in any way? If so, how? Were the impacts short or long term? • What lessons were learned (if any) from this event? • Other unique characteristics about your natural hazard
5	References	-proper in-text citations, using APA-style -reference list provided includes all sources, cited using APA-style -only scholarly sources (i.e. books, government websites, academic websites, and/or peer-reviewed journal articles) are cited -figures and diagrams are properly referenced
50	**Total**	